LET THE MUSIC BEGIN

DHRUV BEDI, 31

Sitarist, Delhi

When Dhruv Bedi was born, his grandfather didn't sing him lullabies but whispered *taans* (note patterns) in his ears. That's how he started learning music from his grandfather, Tara Chand Bedi, and father and sitar maestro, Jagdeep Singh Bedi. Later, he trained under Pandit Budhaditya Mukherjee, a sitar maestro of the Imdadkhani *gharana*. His was a single-minded pursuit—when his teachers would ask him what he wanted to do professionally, his answer would always be, "I want to be a musician." He wants the world to listen to his music, and feels that being a musician is a divine gift. He hopes he can impart that divinity into his music. "Though I experiment, my core remains that of Hindustani classical music. The *raaagdari* is what I firmly believe in," he says. His style is unique, lyrical and rich in melody. ■

– S. Sahaya Ranjit

GLOBAL CONNECT He has collaborated with musicians from Korea and Russia and dabbled in both jazz and Carnatic music

"Dhruv is promising. He has the right *tayyari* and *taleem*"

–Pandit Madhup Mudgal
Hindustani classical vocalist

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

